of the government and the RBI… It depends on the capacity of the (printing) press. When I was in the RBI, and if that is the position, *it will take six months to print the currency notes*. Whether they have made any advance preparation or they started printing early … I don't know.'

The Reverse Bank of India

As the demonetization saga unfolded, the RBI issued a stream of notifications and amendments that got more confusing with each passing day. The RBI became the butt of jokes on mainstream media and social media, and mockingly began to be referred to as the 'Reverse Bank of India'.[42]

A total of 63 notifications pertaining to demonetization were issued by the RBI during 8 November–30 December period, and a further five between 1 January and 30 March 2017. A list of these notifications is attached in Appendix 3. These were in addition to the Standing Orders issued by the Department of Economic Affairs (DEA) in the MoF – which were often contradictory and compounded the confusion.

The first Standing Order by the DEA, S.O. 3407(E), stipulated the rules for depositing and exchanging SBNs and prescribed limits of how much cash individuals could withdraw from their bank accounts.

The second notification, S.O. 3408(E), listed the transactions for which demonetized notes could continue to be used. On 8 November, this was a list of eight, during the course of the demonetization period, it was expanded eventually to 20 types of transactions. Initially intended for a period of only two days, the exemptions were extended first till 24 November and then till 15 December. As reports started surfacing that people could be using these exemptions to get rid of black money, fresh notifications were issued, restricting permission to use old notes to pay for fuel and electricity, and limiting the use of demonetized notes at petrol pumps and airline ticket counters to 3